Stephen Howe

Design Engineer

Norwich, UK | Remote: UK, EU and US-East | Permanent or contract
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Professional summary

Designer and hands-on builder combining product and interaction design with React, TypeScript and full-stack personal projects. Lead Designer at UNCX Network from November 2021 to November 2026, with 20+ years across design and technology. I turn complex requirements into user flows, reusable components and working interfaces, using AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor), automated testing and CI. Background in 3D and motion brings an additional focus on visual craft and interaction detail.

Professional experience

Lead Designer | UNCX Network (SDDTech OÜ)

November 2021 - November 2026 | Remote | Multi-chain decentralised finance (DeFi) products

- Sole in-house designer across brand, product, 3D, motion and marketing, working with developers and external creative partners.
- Led the 2022 rebrand from Unicrypt to UNCX Network, directed an outside studio on the 2024 rebrand and completed the website, Academy and 10+ pages in-house; designed 5+ sub-brands.
- Designed wireframes and UI concepts for 10+ applications, with 3-4 shipped to production; mapped token-tool and Telegram workflows in FigJam and Figma.
- Designed a variable-driven Figma design system for cross-product navigation, now live across the product suite.
- Produced 200+ tutorials, explainers and launch videos, including 30+ for UNCX Academy, and built the 3D and motion template system behind them.
- Created four AI-generated launch films for partner Quiver, rendered locally with Wan 2.2 in ComfyUI.
- Designed and built Solana Diary for a UNCX partner: a 7-service pipeline turning live Solana data into on-brand X graphics, with human approval before every post.

Designer | Switch Studios

July 2018 - June 2021 | Ipswich, UK | HTML5 casino games

- Delivered design and production assets for 30 shipped games, 20+ still live in market, as an embedded member of the development team.
- Created graphics, animation, 3D and launch marketing packs (50+ videos); built sprite sheets and committed work directly through Git and SVN.
- Supported localisation into multiple languages, accessibility adaptations and asset QA across concurrent releases.

Designer and Animator | Howe Creative (Freelance)

May 2016 - August 2018 | International clients | Video, animation and web

- Delivered video, motion graphics and web projects, including 130+ videos for one corporate-learning client by January 2018.
- Filmed, edited and delivered a 6.5-hour chef-training course and website for Chalet Chardons; recipes and operational content by head chef Maciek Dolasinski.
- Produced music videos and explainers with rotoscoping and colour grading; improved website UI, content and SEO for international leisure clients.

Earlier experience: Qtac Solutions, 2nd Line Support Technician and website redesign (2014 - 2016); Burger Theory, Web & Social Media Manager (2012 - 2016, concurrent); Hot Biscuit, Venue & Promotions Manager (2011 - 2012); 412 Promotions, Brand Manager (2009 - 2011); Right Click Computers, Junior Helpdesk Technician (2008 - 2009); BBC, Database Technician (2007 - 2008); Good Salon Guide, Web Manager & Graphic Designer (2005 - 2006).

Selected projects

Badger Club

2026 | Personal project | In development

Designed and built a badge-tracking product for youth leaders with Next.js, Supabase, Google authentication and Resend, owning the UI, database design with row-level security, and CI security and regression suites.

howecreative.co.uk/work/badger-club

Solana Diary

2026 | UNCX partner | Archived

Designed the brand and templates, and built seven Railway services connecting live-data APIs, code-driven rendering, rate limiting, Telegram approval and X publishing. Every post required human approval. Built with AI tools; Grok was an optional, button-triggered assist.

howecreative.co.uk/work/solana-diary

UNCX Unified Menu

2026 | Professional work | Implemented

Researched navigation patterns and designed a shared product hierarchy with variable-driven Figma components, documented states and configurable content. Balanced product priority with discoverability. Signed off and implemented across the product suite.

howecreative.co.uk/work/uncx-menu

Noticia Lingo

2026 | Personal project | In development

Designed and built a language-learning app from news articles with Next.js, Supabase and Google authentication: learning levels, a multilingual framework, Playwright and accessibility tests, and Sentry monitoring.

howecreative.co.uk/work/noticia-lingo

Core skills

Development: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, Three.js / React Three Fiber, GSAP, Git, Bash, Vercel.

AI-assisted development: Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, OpenCode, agentic build workflows, multi-agent review and audit gates, prompt and guidance systems.

Testing, data and CI: Vitest, Jest, Playwright, accessibility testing (axe), property-based and mutation testing, GitHub Actions, CircleCI, Supabase, PostgreSQL, row-level security, Google OAuth, Sentry.

Product and interaction design: UI/UX, user flows, wireframing, rapid prototyping, Figma, FigJam, design systems, component libraries, developer handoff, Agile and Scrum.

Local and generative AI: LM Studio, Hermes and other local LLMs, ComfyUI (image, video and audio), Wan 2.2, ElevenLabs, AI music generation, automated publishing with approval gates, API integration.

Creative production: Art direction, brand identity, 3D, motion design, Cinema 4D, Redshift, X-Particles, After Effects, Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator, Ableton Live, Audition.

Education

BSc (Hons) Entertainment Technology, First Class

University of Portsmouth | 2007. IBM Prize for Best Creative Technologies Project. Dissertation: 90%, highest in the department.

Full Stack Coding Bootcamp

Tech Educators | March 2024. 12-week intensive: React, Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL and Supabase.

Languages

English: native. Spanish: working proficiency.